

9.4 FreeMind And The Outside World

All we've talked about thus far involves using FreeMind for yourself - what happens when you want to share your ideas with the world, and have them share theirs with you? More importantly, if you've created a mind map for a proposal and want to e-mail it to someone, you can't really expect them to download FreeMind just because you want them to, right? There are many ways to share your mind map with others, starting with a simple text dump to using it online in your Wiki.

9.4.1 Sharing Maps With Others

More than one person working on the same mind map can easily lead to chaos, so FreeMind provides a couple of handy tools to track changes made to the mind map. Go to Tools > Show Modification Times to show the date and time of node creation and modifications in a tool-tip when you hover the mouse cursor over a node. To view the entire history of the mind map, go to Tools > Show Map History.

To ensure no new change goes unnoticed, select Tools > Show Revisions in Yellow. Once all this is done, you'll be better equipped to share your mind map. Still, FreeMind is primarily a ~personal~ tool, so don't go about sharing your map with too many people.

9.4.2 Exporting Mind Maps

The simplest way to export a mind map is by selecting the central node, hitting [Ctrl] + [C] to copy, and pasting it in your text editor. Child nodes will be indented as you go down the trees, so the result looks much like this:

```
My Mind Map
  A Child Node
    Another child node
      A grandchild node?
        And another
          Link Me! <#Freemind_Link_1184257709> ~ (These are local
```